The Pre-Import Checklist for China Machinery

Macacy Consulting | 48 Verification Points

This checklist covers the 48 verification points we complete on every order. It is the same document our team uses before a single deposit leaves Nigeria.

How to use it: Take it to your supplier conversation. Ask every question before you pay anything. Mark each point ✓ **Confirmed in writing**, **? Unclear** or ✗ **Not confirmed**. A verbal answer does not count. If your supplier cannot answer, that is your first red flag.

Have ready: your facility's voltage, phase and frequency (from your electrician or utility bill), the raw material you will run, and the daily output you need.

Part A: The Core 15

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
1	Voltage compatibility: facility vs. machine spec	What voltage is the machine rated for, and does it match my measured supply? (Many Chinese factories default to 380V. Nigerian industrial supply is typically 415V.)
2	Phase compatibility: single vs. three-phase	Is the machine single-phase or three-phase, and does that match my site?
3	Frequency compatibility: 50Hz vs. 60Hz	Are the motors and controls rated for 50Hz?
4	Voltage fluctuation tolerance: ±15-20%	Does the spec sheet state tolerance for ±15-20%, or does it need a stabiliser?
5	Spare parts availability: local vs. China	Which wear parts can be bought locally, and which must come from China?
6	Spare parts pipeline: documented supplier	Who supplies replacement parts, and can you confirm lead times in writing?
7	Installation requirements: power, foundation, air, water	What power, foundation, compressed air and water does the machine need at my site?

8	Site power stability: stable three-phase confirmed	Has my site's three-phase supply been measured as stable, or does it depend on a generator?
9	Operator skill level: technician vs. operator	Does it need a trained technician or a general operator?
10	Training requirements: identified and planned	Is training included, in what language, and who delivers it?
11	Material input compatibility: locally available inputs	Was the machine built and tested for the exact material I will feed it?
12	Output specification: capacity, speed, quality	What capacity, speed and quality do you guarantee, and is it written into the contract?
13	Control panel language: English interface required	Are the control panel, manual and alarm messages in English, and is that in the purchase order?
14	Pre-shipment inspection: third-party firm confirmed	Which independent firm will inspect before the container is sealed?
15	Documentation: Form M, Commercial Invoice, Bill of Landing	Will all documents match each other before shipment?

Part B: The Remaining 33

Power compatibility

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
16	Motor nameplate rating	Are the nameplate figures (kW, V, Hz, A) stated in the quotation?
17	Transformer, stabiliser or soft starter	Does the machine need one, and who supplies it?
18	Total power load	What is the load in kW or kVA, and can my supply or generator carry it?
19	Generator compatibility	Is the machine suitable for generator power and its start-up current?

20	Written power specification	Are voltage, phase and frequency written into the purchase order as binding?

Spare parts

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
21	Critical parts brand	Which brand are the PLC, drive and motor, and does that brand have local support?
22	Spare parts kit	Is a kit included, with its contents listed in writing?
23	Replacement lead time	How long does a replacement part take to arrive from China?
24	Warranty parts shipping	Who pays shipping for parts replaced under warranty?

Installation and site

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
25	Dimensions and weight	Do my doors, floor loading and crane access allow it in?
26	Foundation and anchoring	What foundation specification is required?
27	Ambient conditions	What heat, dust and humidity can it tolerate?
28	Installation and commissioning	Who installs and commissions it, and is that in the price?
29	Utility connections	Who supplies the cables, pipes and fittings to connect it?

Operators and training

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
30	Operating and maintenance manual	Is it supplied in English, with a maintenance schedule?

31	Technician support	Who do I call when it stops, and how fast will they respond?
32	Commissioning handover	Is there a test run with my operators present?

Material input and output

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
33	Raw material specification	What moisture, particle size, hardness and temperature range does it accept?
34	Factory test run	Has my material (or a sample) been run through the machine?
35	Shortfall remedy	What happens if output misses the guaranteed figure?

Control panel and interface

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
36	Wiring diagram	Is it supplied in English?
37	Software and settings	Is any software or licence needed, and are the settings documented?

Pre-shipment inspection

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
38	Inspection scope	Is the scope written down (function test, voltage test, nameplate check, photos)?
39	Report before balance payment	Will I receive the full report before I release the balance?
40	Failed inspection remedy	What happens if it fails: rework, delay or refund?
41	Packing and crating	Is it rated for sea freight and Nigerian port handling?

Documentation and customs

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
42	HS code and duty estimate	Is the HS code agreed, and has the duty been estimated?
43	Certificate of Origin and Packing List	Will both be supplied?
44	Import approvals	Does the machine need product certification or special approval?
45	Clearing agent review and demurrage budget	Has my clearing agent checked the documents before shipment, and have I budgeted for delays?

Payment structure and protection

#	Verification point	Ask the supplier
46	Milestone payments	Is payment tied to milestones, not 100% upfront, and released only after verification and inspection?
47	Supplier identity	Does the bank account name match the company on the invoice, and is the business licence verified?
48	Warranty and late-delivery remedy	Is a written warranty in place, with a remedy for late delivery?

Scoring

- **All 48 confirmed in writing:** you are ready to commit.
- **Any of points 1–4, 11, 15 or 46–48 not confirmed:** stop. These cause the costliest failures.
- **More than 5 unclear points:** do not pay a deposit yet.

Want us to check it for you? Send us your supplier's quotation and your facility details, and we will go through all 48 points before you pay. WhatsApp: +234 703 917 2842